

Directory Sync Settings

Last updated by | Erik Ralston | Sep 20, 2021 at 7:03 AM PDT

The following article outlines the behavior of the Soundbite (SB) Directory Sync Settings, which is a user interface (UI) that enables Soundbite administrators to enable and configure the synchronization of groups and users from their organization's directory (EG, Azure Active Directory, Okta, etc).

Enabling the sync feature requires organization-wide admin permissions that should be coordinated with organization-wide IT decision-makers. If you need help working through a security review or similar process, please reach out to Support@Soundbite.AI.

Planning

Before beginning with the configuration, it's important to have a plan. This means having determined the system with which you will synchronize (EG, Azure Active Directory) and a list of groups and/or users you wish to synchronize by name. This will enable you to quickly and easily configure and test the sync.

For most organizations, simply having a set of selected groups is the best strategy to get started. This is especially true during the early pilot phases where most organizations take an incremental approach to add teams as they become enthusiastic early adopters of the platform. Since it only takes SB Admins a few seconds to add more teams, which they can do any time after the organization-wide IT teams grant the platform read-only access, it is easy to start small and grow over time.

Fully adopted organizations should consider enabling both "Selected Groups" and "All Users". This will provide a positive user experience by providing a curated set of teams into the system while providing the most value out of Soundbite. Most critically, this allows the platform to be accessed via integrations (EG, SB Widgets hosted in SharePoint) no matter the origin of the user in your organization. Remember, the sync process is access to the **platform**, not just the UI of SB Studio. Role-based access control (RBAC) for communication and collaboration organization-wide relies upon administrators having allowed access for all users organization-wide.

Keep in mind that sync is a background-only process and new users being synced into the system will NOT receive any onboarding notifications. This means you are in full control of how users are introduced to SB since you can organize your own communications about the platform. By default, users will still receive notifications regarding the content being published on Soundbite once added, when they are manually added to the system, and when they are manually "invited" via their e-mail to the system. For small organizations and small-scale pilots, using the invite system to send onboarding communications is a quick and easy way to get started, but in large organizations where technology adoption requires more than simply informing the users of availability, it's best to organize an adoption campaign. If you need help organizing such an effort, reach out to Support@Soundbite.AI.

Additional Options

As of this writing (September 2021), the sync UI exposes the most common scenarios for sync, but not all supported scenarios for sync. There are additional options that could be used as alternatives if requested via Support@Soundbite.AI, for instance:

- Synchronization of groups without related members, which would enable keep categories of users in groups, but maintain their membership manually in Soundbite

Clarifications

The sync does NOT incur downtime, so the timing of when one configures and tests Soundbite Sync will have no bearing on ongoing operations.

The sync does NOT automatically disable user and team management within SB Studio. For instance, you can still add users to existing groups if you want guest collaborators without requiring access to the directory. This is helpful if you want to add additional folks who might want to "listen in" on all team sessions or outside vendors who are not in the directory group, but you want logically added to the group in SB for a temporary duration. Keep in mind that the platform can include a custom list of users and groups on a per-session basis, so this technique should only be used if you want individuals to have constant access.

The sync does NOT remove users, groups, and members in situations where the origin of a user loses context and that may happen in some contexts when the sync is re-configured. For instance:

- The "All Groups" or "All Users" sync functionality are always based on nightly deltas of the org-wide group and user lists. This will result in accurately adding and removing records virtually all of the time if left continuously on; however, fully disabling the functionality, then re-enabling it - especially with a waiting period in-between - will destroy the context of the ongoing sync and will likely cause the next sync to only add users/groups, not remove anything based on the intermediary operations in the directory. It will then continue from that point with accurate add/remove behavior.
- The "Selected Groups" functionality will add related users, groups, and members as needed by the sync. If one adds a group and lets the system sync, then the users within the group are added to Soundbite. If one then uses the UI to remove the group, the membership of the contained users ARE deactivated; however, the user records themselves are NOT removed from Soundbite. While this may "orphan" that users without any groups, this is to preserve the user record in instances where they are participants in multiple groups. Basically, one should think of user records as the foundational type of record and group/memberships as lower-priority mapping records that bind them together, but do NOT manage the lifecycle of the more permanent user records connected to them to the extent where they "own" the user records in any way.

All removal actions are "soft deletes". This means that they can be easily restored in the future; however, there are situations where the items can be restored manually by SB Support, but then removed again by the sync mechanism due to further changes. Similarly, manually removing a user does NOT prevent the sync from potentially adding that user back based on the directory state and SB sync configuration in the future. For instance, by default the "All Users" functionality - if left on continuously - will allow admins to remove a user from the system and NOT restore that user automatically on the next sync. However, if one disables sync entirely and re-enables the "All Users" mode, it will have lost context and will restore that removed user if the directory reflects them being currently active in the org. **For this reason, it is recommended that admins focus on allowing SB to purely mirror the directory and try to minimize manual user management once the sync is enabled.**

Next Run

The sync UI always shows the next automatic run of sync. This is when the process will sync again in a 24 hour period at midnight (UTC). This maintains data over time and allows for the shifting access to Soundbite based on changes over time.

Soundbite Directory Sync

Next automatic run is 9/20/2021, 5:00:00 PM local time.

Default View

By default, the sync process is disabled. This means it will display a summary page that outlines some starting documentation:

Disabled Azure Active Directory (Office 365)

Directory sync connects your organization's users and groups from your directory data every day at midnight UTC.

The configuration allows directory sync to fetch information using a configured mix of four strategies:

- **Selected Groups (Recommended)** - Groups you select and their members only.
- **Selected Users** - Users on a selected list, regardless of group membership.
- **All Users** - All licensed users in your organization, including potential guest users, which allows maximum use of Soundbite.
- **All Groups** - Loading all groups into the system. Convenient for small organizations, but usually too much for large ones.

If you have any questions or need any advice on your directory sync configuration, please reach out to us at Support@Soundbite.AI.

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This gives useful advice for planning your sync process and reaching out to Support@Soundbite.AI to help with going through review processes and planning efforts.

Azure Active Directory (Office 365)

For a [summary of the general capabilities of Azure Active Directory \(Office 365\) Directory Sync](#), please read the [related article "Directory Sync - Azure Active Directory \(AAD\)"](#). For a [description of the exact data underlying this configuration UI](#), please read the [related article "Available Azure Active Directory Sync Data"](#). Both are also available by request from Support@Soundbite.AI.

Tenant ID Picker

The AAD Tenant ID is the UUID of the target Active Directory instance. As of this writing, this will lock onto the currently logged-in user's Tenant ID based on the login information of the user. **Only admin users of the actual directory should attempt to perform first set up the sync due to it requiring admin permission to properly onboard, thus this field is NOT configurable.**

Disabled Azure Active Directory (Office 365)



Tenant ID

e5f75632-637d-4d2e-a8a7-e8f6993acb74

[View in Azure Portal](#)

SB partners deploying on an organization's behalf are completely reliant on an IT resource within the client organization clicking this button and enabling the settings the first time. If the sync is disabled in the future, then it must be re-enabled by a member of that organization each time; otherwise, it will likely connect to the tech partner's organization and start syncing content from the partner's directory instead of the client's directory.

Grant Admin Access

This view detects that the current sync settings do NOT have admin access to the currently indicated AAD tenant, showing a button that prompts the current user to grant read-only access to the current organization's AAD information. **This should only be enabled by an organization-wide IT admin who was approved by an organization-wide IT decision-maker**, because it gives organization-wide read-only access:

Disabled Azure Active Directory (Office 365)

 Tenant ID e5f75632-637d-4d2e-a8a7-e8f6993acb74 [View in Azure Portal](#)

Getting Started

To get started, an Azure Active Directory (AAD or AD) administrator must first grant Soundbite the [Directory.Read.All Application permission](#), which allows for read-only access to AAD without user interaction.

Administrators can read and configure [Azure Active Directory settings in the Azure Portal](#). If you need any assistance for security review or understanding the best directory sync approach for your organization, please reach out to Support@Soundbite.AI.

 Grant Admin Access

Microsoft Permissions

In the case of AAD, after choosing to grant admin access - again, an action that can only be done by an AAD admin at the target organization - there will be a prompt to allow for the following read-only permissions:

- **Maintain access to your data** - This key permission allows the SB Platform to have read-only access to organization data while running as a background process. This is necessary since there is no user interaction for automatic syncing.
- **Sign in and read user profile** - This provides read-only access to the current user's profile. This is default permission used by virtually all applications to facilitate UI-driven interactions.
- **Read Directory Data** - This is the key permission to read the users and groups in your organization, enabling SB to mirror their structure to provide RBAC.



erik@soundbite.ai

Permissions requested Review for your organization

Soundbite Platform
soundbite.ai

This application is not published by Microsoft.

This app would like to:

^ Maintain access to data you have given it access to

Allows the app to see and update the data you gave it access to, even when users are not currently using the app. This does not give the app any additional permissions.

This is a permission requested to access your data in Soundbite Inc.

^ Sign in and read user profile

^ Read directory data

Allows the app to read data in your organization's directory, such as users, groups and apps, without a signed-in user.

This is a permission requested to access your data in Soundbite Inc.

If you accept, this app will get access to the specified resources for all users in your organization. No one else will be prompted to review these permissions.

Accepting these permissions means that you allow this app to use your data as specified in their terms of service and privacy statement. **The publisher has not provided links to their terms for you to review.** You can change these permissions at <https://myapps.microsoft.com>. [Show details](#)

Does this app look suspicious? [Report it here](#)

Cancel

Accept

NOTE: There may be a few minutes delay between granting these permissions and access being fully granted by AAD to the SB Platform app. This will be indicated by the "Grant Admin Access" view reappearing even though the "Accept" button was pressed on this screen and the permissions should have been granted. In this event, try periodically refreshing the page until the "Getting Started" view outlined below appears on the screen.

Getting Started

If the current organization DOES have the permission granted outlined above, but the current settings do not reflect using AAD, there is a distinct "Getting Started" screen that will show indicating AAD connection will be enabled by saving. Admin permission is NOT needed to successfully save from this screen; however, **only a member of the target organization should hit save on this screen** since the Tenant ID field displayed on the screen locks to the current user's directory. Please click the "View in Azure Portal" button next to the Tenant ID to confirm that you are targeting the correct AAD instance before proceeding, then click the "Save" button.

Disabled

Azure Active Directory (Office 365)

Tenant ID

e5f75632-637d-4d2e-a8a7-e8f6993acb74

[View in Azure Portal](#)

Getting Started

Thank you for granting permission to the Soundbite platform. We are ready to connect to your Azure Active Directory (Office 365) tenant. Once activated, you will be able to sync:

- **Users**, including guests, who are members of your organization.
- **Groups** in your organization, including O365 and security groups, plus distribution lists.

Save

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Groups

The groups control offer three modes for syncing groups:

- **Selected Groups (Recommended):** Sync the selected allowlist of groups and their related users. This is the recommended setting for most organizations.
- **All Groups:** All groups in the org, including security groups, etc. This is recommended for small organizations that have very little content.
- **Disabled** - This will skip syncing any groups to the system and only currently configured groups will be available. This will NOT remove any existing records that were added via a prior run of the sync process.

Groups Microsoft 365 and security groups, plus Distribution lists, including Mail-Enabled Security. [View Groups](#)

No Groups

Selected Groups

All Groups

The following groups will be visible as Teams in Soundbite and their members will be added as users:

Customer Success x

x

▼

Keep in mind that members of a group always arrive as regular members when added. If you wish for them to be appointed as "Owners" of the group, then you must go into that particular Group via the Admin area of Soundbite and enable the "Owner" role for the desired user. For most organizations, it's possible to simply have a handful of SB org-wide admins and allow the directory sync to completely handle adding/removing users to the system and groups, so many organizations request that Support@Soundbite.AI disable all other user management for the organization.

Users

This is the list of individuals who will have the ability to access Soundbite, including Soundbite Studio and widgets embedded in other integrated platforms (EG, SB Widgets hosted in SharePoint). "Users" in this context reflects all individuals shown in the AAD users lists, which may include guest users on that list.

The users control offers three modes for syncing users:

- **Selected Users** - An allowlist of users to be synced nightly, including updating all profile information. This is recommended for organizations that wish to trial Soundbite with a select handful of users without automatically managing groups via the "Selected Groups" functionality.
- **All Users** - Users in the organization, including adds/removals over time. This is recommended for organizations wanting 100% availability of Soundbite across all users in the organization.
- **Disabled** - Unless a user is part of a group coming into Soundbite via the "Groups" configuration, users will NOT be synced into the organization whatsoever. This will NOT remove any existing records that may have been previously added via the sync process.

Users Licensed organization members and guest users. [View Users](#)



Users on the following list, plus any in groups above, will be synchronized:



All users are synced via their e-mail address. This means changing the e-mail address of a user will load a new record for them. Conversely, reusing an e-mail address will hijack the pre-existing record rather than mak a new one. In the event, your organization habitually reuses e-mail addresses for different people - not a recommended best practice for any organization - then please contact Support@Soundbite.AI to strategize on a process to adapt. All other profile fields (Given Name, Family Name, Phone Number, Title) will be changed on each sync to match the directory, reflecting the new values automatically.

Keep in mind that when users are added to SB, they all arrive as regular users of the system. If you wish to add them as a Soundbite "Admin" for your organization, you must go to the Users area of the Soundbite settings and enable the administrator role for them. It is recommended you choose to maintain only a handful of administrators for org-wide actions and allow directory sync to manage all other participants in the system.

Keep in mind that the SB Platform still handles all login via AAD SSO, thus users appearing in the system from this sync is still subservient to their access and licensing in AAD (Office 365). This means that a recently removed user from AAD will not be able to consume or create in SB immediately upon disabling their account in AAD. SB

does NOT need to run a sync to remove that user before that login is disabled. EG, Your organization is fully adopted, so the "All Users" mode is configured in SB. The IT admin disables a retiring employee's account at 7PM Pacific, but the sync run won't fire until 5PM Pacific (Daylight) the next day. In those intervening 20 hours, the user will still show in the list of users in SB, but they will NOT be able to access or login to SB, because AAD will NOT authorize their access since they were disabled by the directory and that is checked every time they log in to the system.

Results

The Sync Results view appears after a manual sync run from this UI. Keep in mind that sync runs automatically every midnight (UTC), so it's never necessary to use this manual sync for anything more than testing the result of a configuration.

The results include a variety of fields to help understand the extent to which data was added to the system, along with easy links to the Users and Groups list in Soundbite. When visiting the Users and Groups views, it may be necessary to refresh them to see the changes enacted by your sync run.

Sync Results

Directory sync successful.

DIMENSION	VALUE
Directory Type	AAD
Duration	1 Second(s)
Memory	1 MB(s)
User API Requests	1
Users Added	0
Users Updated	5
Group API Requests	2
Groups Added	0
Groups Updated	1
Groups Removed	0
Members Added	0
Members Removed	0

To see changes, check your [Teams](#) and [Users](#) .

Conclusion

Thank you for choosing Soundbite and the easy-to-use Directory Sync functionality to simplify giving everyone a voice in your organization. If you have any questions or feedback, please reach out to Support@Soundbite.AI.